



FORMS

Web Design Accessibility

LABELS

- Inputs should be paired with labels

Government Gateway user ID

This could be up to 12 characters.

Password

Sign in

```
<label for="userId">User ID</label>
```

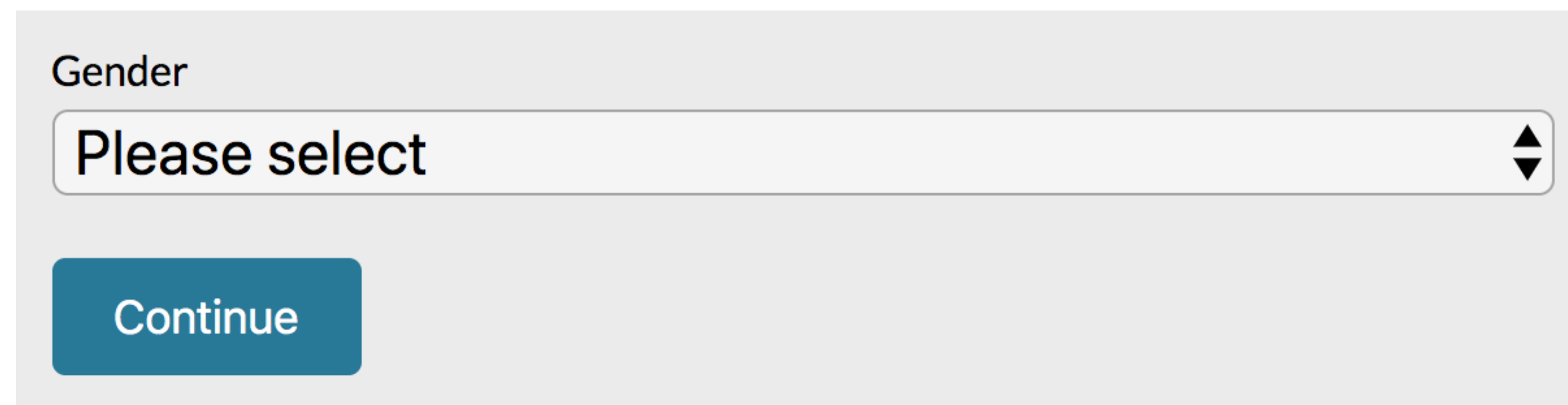
```
<input type="text" id="userId"  
name="userId" />
```

PLACEHOLDERS

- Placeholders are not a replacement for labels
- They should act as an additional hint, rather than presenting the same information as the label
- For example, `placeholder="Date of birth"` should be avoided because this information should already be placed in the label
- Whereas `placeholder="DD/MM/YYYY"` provides an additional hint
- Or just avoid them altogether

DISABLING BUTTONS

- Avoid using the `disabled` attribute on buttons
- Adding the `disabled` attribute takes the button out of the tab index and therefore essentially disappears from the page
- If the form is not in a submit-able state, allow the user to submit anyway and tell them what they need to change



Gender

Please select

Continue

The image shows a light gray rectangular form. At the top left, the word 'Gender' is written in a dark gray sans-serif font. Below it is a white dropdown menu with a thin gray border. Inside the dropdown, the text 'Please select' is written in a bold, dark gray sans-serif font. To the right of the text is a small dark gray icon consisting of two triangles pointing up and down. Below the dropdown menu is a solid blue button with rounded corners. The word 'Continue' is written on the button in a white sans-serif font.

HANDLING ERRORS

- This is the most difficult part of making forms accessible
- It must be clear to the user that the form is invalid and what needs to be changed
- Ideally, take the user to the source of the error
- You can use `aria-describedby` to identify the error for that field

```
<label for="email">Email address</label>
```

```
<input type="email" name="name" aria-invalid="true"  
aria-describedby="email-error-details" />
```

```
<p id="email-error-details">This email address is  
already registered.</p>
```